A GLOBAL MOVEMENT FOR INTERNATIONAL EPILEPSY DAY

50 *million* STEPS

Take a Step Against Stigma

International Epilepsy Day · **10 February 2025**

INTERNATIONAL BUREAU FOR EPILEPSY



THE PROBLEM

50 million people. Half face stigma.

50M

people worldwide live with epilepsy — a WHO estimate.

Recent research suggests the true number may be higher.

1/2

of them experience some form of stigma — misunderstanding, discrimination, exclusion.

WHY NOW In 2022, WHO member states unanimously adopted the 10-year **Interagency Global Action Plan on epilepsy and other neurological disorders (IGAP)** — to reduce stigma, impact and burden, and improve quality of life for people with epilepsy, their caregivers and families. Epilepsy receives special attention, with dedicated global targets.

CAMPAIGN OBJECTIVES

Three objectives, one direction

#50MillionSteps is the kickoff activity for International Epilepsy Day — **10 February 2025** — aligned with the **#EpilepsyDay** goals.

01 → Raise awareness about epilepsy

Bring epilepsy into everyday conversation — so it is seen, understood and talked about.

02 → Dispel the myths and misconceptions

Challenge the fears and misunderstandings surrounding epilepsy — much of the stigma comes from not knowing.

03 Improve knowledge across all sectors of society

Build real understanding about epilepsy in every part of society — schools, workplaces and communities.

THE 2025 GOAL

50,000,000

steps

one step for each person living with epilepsy

900,000,000+

steps in five years of the campaign — the momentum behind the target

2024

steps **far exceeded** the goal and expectations — so 2025 aims higher

10

February 2025

ahead of International Epilepsy Day

More steps. More awareness.
More lives improved.

JOIN THE CAMPAIGN

Count your steps. Log them. *Repeat.*

January 6, 2025

Step Counter opens

February 10, 2025

Total steps announced

1

Count

Count your steps as you walk.

2

Log

Log your steps to the Step Counter at www.50millionsteps.org.

3

Repeat

Log at the end of each day — or tally weekly — to track progress together and mark milestones.

Join us at **www.50millionsteps.org**

International Epilepsy Day · 10 February 2025

ACTIVITY OPTIONS

Every body moves.

No one-size-fits-all approach. Whatever you do, every step counts towards our goal.

Walking
The core of the campaign — count your daily steps.

Biking
Pedal your way — log your cycling miles.

Dance
Organize a dance-a-thon; log sessions as steps.

Step & Stretch
Yoga, pilates, tai chi — mindful walks to practice.

Swimming
Every lap in the pool adds to your count.

Skiing / Snowboarding
Turn winter adventures into steps.

Dog walking
Combine your love of dogs with the cause.

Fitness classes
Partner with studios for step-count workouts.



COUNT EVERY KIND OF MOVEMENT

No tracker? Estimate your steps.

GENERAL BASELINE **≈ 1,350** steps / km

An average person walks ≈ 3.8 km in 5,000 steps

ACTIVITY	STEP EQUIVALENT
Running	≈ **2,000** steps / mile
Yoga 30 minutes	≈ **5,000–7,000** steps
Dancing 30 minutes	≈ **5,000–7,000** steps
Cycling per minute	≈ **1,000–1,500** steps

No matter how you track your activity, *every step counts* towards our goal!



COMMUNITY MOBILIZATION

Mobilize your community.

One person walking is participation. A community walking together is a movement.

01 **Step-a-thon**

Organize a step-count competition in your community — teams, targets and friendly rivalry.

02 **Walk and Talk**

Create a safe space for open dialogue, promote inclusivity, and help others learn about living with epilepsy.

03 **Step challenges**

Weekly themed challenges with different goals — for example, “High Energy Steps”.

Where? **Schools · workplaces · local communities**

AMPLIFY ON SOCIAL MEDIA

#50MillionSteps #StepAgainstStigma

Use both tags in every post



Illustrative mockup — copy from the official toolkit

WHAT TO SHARE

- → Your daily or weekly step count
- → Selfies from your walks
- → Photos & videos — and tag @IBE

REMEMBER TO

Spread the word
Share every step

Educate others
Challenge stigma

Celebrate success
Yours & the campaign's

Follow IBE: facebook.com/InternationalBureauForEpilepsy · instagram.com/international_epilepsy · twitter.com/IBESocialMedia

RESOURCES

Your campaign toolkit.

You don't have to start from scratch. IBE provides ready-to-use campaign graphics for advocates and organizations.



X / TWITTER



INSTAGRAM



FACEBOOK



EDITABLE SELFIE CARD

Also in the toolkit — **Posters 1–4** (PDF/PNG) · **Campaign logo** “Steps Against Stigma” (transparent PNG)

USAGE **Free for individual advocates and non-profit organizations.** Commercial companies must contact IBE for approval.

Contact: Marie Ennis O'Connor, Head of Communications · communications@ibe-epilepsy.org

JOIN THE MOVEMENT

When we walk in step together, nothing is *impossible.*

50millionsteps.org #50MillionSteps · #StepAgainstStigma



INTERNATIONAL BUREAU FOR EPILEPSY